

taken by them regarding the COVID-19 outbreak from Rajendran Dandapani, Director of Technology, Zoho Corp.

Zoho has taken steps to make working from home as easy as possible. This includes Zoho Remotely, a set of 11 productivity and collaboration tools. These include a chat feature in Cliq, online meetings via Meeting, webinar and training sessions via ShowTime, project management through Projects and Sprints, an office suite with WorkDrive, and finally, remote assistance via Assist and Lens software. Furthermore Zoho have made these software free for all businesses in India until June 1.

Zoho has also started the ESAP (Emergency Subscription Assistance Program) initiative to help out small business customers around the world who have been affected by the novel coronavirus pandemic. Through this initiative, these customers can avail and make use of Zoho's software for free for up to three months.

Lastly, the Zoho Creator COVID-19 App Program has been set up to help non-profits, government organisations and community-level organisations by providing them with free applications to help them work efficiently.

PERSISTENT SYSTEMS

Persistent Systems is an Indian company that builds custom software for businesses. We reached out to the company to find out how they're helping in the fight against COVID-19. Vinod Parale, AVP & GM - Healthcare & Life Sciences responded to us.

Persistent is helping healthcare systems, insurance companies and life sciences companies better care for their patients and customers during the pandemic. Using their technology solutions and app, they're helping healthcare systems and the general public use their tools to self-assess the risk that comes with COVID-19. The app helps medical personnel better access the severity of the infection in those who are affected and help them decide the course of medical action to be taken. The app also allows patients to have video visits and get advice from doctors remotely. Persistent has also built solutions to help hospitals monitor patients remotely.

Persistent is also helping some drive-through testing labs decide who should be tested for COVID-19 based on their symptoms. Using Persistent's solutions, labs can better manage coronavirus testing kits and PPE supplies. They're also helping speed up the testing process, from analysing data to providing results more accurately.

The company is working on building solutions which will allow government agencies and large enterprises to decide when and how they can start reopening their establishments, by observing certain data and community behavioural patterns.

They're also using tools such as a Surveillance Dashboard to help research institutes better understand and study the spread of COVID-19.

The company worked with the Biocomplexity Institute to help policy makers monitor infections across the planet via the Pandemic Surveillance Dashboard. They have worked with governments in the past for other outbreaks. During these outbreaks, they developed tools for the public as well as healthcare systems to guide and support them, and help with effective intervention and resource allocation. These tools are coming in handy now during the COVID-19 outbreak. The COVID-19 Surveillance Dashboard uses historical data from the onset of the outbreak and allows users to see a progression of the virus alongside various other statistics.

WINGIFY

Software company, Wingify's founders, Paras Chopra and Sparsh Gupta have started an initiative around COVID-19 called Coronathon, which is an online, non-profit, volunteer-driven hackathon aimed at building solutions that can help reduce the impact of the novel coronavirus in India. The coronathon has been organised by a team of professionals from India and Hong Kong with backgrounds in tech, innovation and community organisation. The or-

ganisers include Paras Chopra, Sparsh Gupta, Sathish Raghuraman, Vivek Vennelakanti, Arun Patre, Akash Tandon, Ankit Jain, Chandresh Vaghanani, Prerna Bagga, Cynthia Rajan, Shruti Royyuru and Kriti Kathuria.

The coronathon was launched on March 22 and currently has over 2900 volunteers. The volunteers mainly

comprise of software developers, designers, engineers, product managers, consultants, doctors, writers, marketers, bureaucrats, and students. The projects for the hackathon are built around nine categories which include PPE sourcing, essential services,

contact tracing and quarantine, case trackers, pandemic logistics, prevention techniques, COVID-19 information, COVID-19 education, and economic solutions. Each of these categories has different projects addressing different issues people are facing during the pandemic. Organisers and volunteers can use the coronathon.in Slack workspace to coordinate, share ideas and skill sets, and drive projects.

Every weekend, Coronathon hosts Demo Days, where teams pitch their solutions before a virtual public audience of several hundred people. This audience includes people from the government, healthcare, tech and investment communities. So far, the Coronathon has hosted 3 Demo Days, and 42 projects, which have been pitched to over 600 people.

MICROSOFT

One of the big five tech companies in the world, Microsoft has taken a few steps to help the battle against COVID-19 in India. Due to the COVID-19 outbreak, the Indian Law that mandated doctors only do in-person consultations has been relaxed. Now, we have legal virtual consultations, to enable safety of both frontline healthcare providers and patients. With this in mind, hospital chains including Fortis Healthcare, and Health Care Global (HCG) have adopted a new feature in

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